

MIZORAM PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION
TECHNICAL COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION FOR
JUNIOR GRADE OF MIZORAM ENGINEERING SERVICE (COMBINED)
UNDER VARIOUS DEPARTMENTS, GOVERNMENT OF MIZORAM.
(OCTOBER - 2025)
GENERAL ENGLISH

Time Allowed : 3 hours

FM : 100

Marks for each question is indicated against it.

Attempt all questions.

1. Write an essay on **any one of the following : (20)**

- Relationship between mental health and modern work culture.
- Efficacy of the current educational system in fostering innovation.
- The imperative of urban planning in enhancing the quality of life.
- The impact of scientific advancements on modern education.

2. Read the following passage carefully and answer the questions that follow in your own words :

The afternoon was warm and the prospect of a dull, prolonged vigil in the beer garden had made me feel vaguely uneasy and almost sad. I felt that Tom would drift on forever seeking a little wistfully for the dramatic turbulence of some irrecoverable football game. And, as I walked on, I was lonely no longer. I was a guide, a pathfinder, an original settler. He had casually conferred on me the freedom of the neighbourhood. And so with the sunshine and the great bursts of leaves growing on the trees, just as things grow in fast movies. I had that familiar conviction that life was beginning over again with the summer.

There was so much to read, for one thing, and so much fine health to be pulled down out of the young breath-giving air. I bought a dozen volumes on banking and credit and investment securities, and they stood on my shelf in red and gold like new money from the mint, promising to unfold the shining secrets that only Midas and Morgan and Maecenas knew. And I had the high intention of reading many other books besides. I was rather literary in college – one year I wrote a series of very solemn and obvious editorials for the “Yale News” and now I was going to bring back all such things into my life and become again that most limited of all specialists, the “well-rounded man.” This isn’t just an epigram – life is much more successfully looked at from a single window, after all.

It was a matter of chance that I should have rented a house in one of the strangest communities in North America. It was on that slender riotous island which extends itself due to East of New York and where there are among other natural curiosities, two unusual formations of land.

Twenty miles from the city a pair of enormous eggs, identical in contour and separated only by a courtesy bay, jut out into the most domesticated body of salt water in the Western Hemisphere, the great wet barnyard of Long Island Sound. They are not perfect ovals – like the egg in the Columbus story, they are both crushed flat at the contact end – but their physical resemblance must be a source

of perpetual confusion to the gulls that fly overhead. To the wingless a more arresting phenomenon is their dissimilarity in every particular except shape and size.

Questions :

- (a) How does the narrator describe the appearance of the books he purchased? (4)
- (b) What conviction did the narrator feel with the arrival of summer? How does the narrator describe his intention to become a “well-rounded man”? (3)
- (c) In the line ‘It was a matter of chance that I should have rented a house in one of the strangest communities in North America.’ What made these communities strange? (2)
- (d) In the given passage, the expression ‘solemn’ means : (1)
 - (i) unfold (ii) thoughtful
 - (iii) obvious (iv) epigram
- (e) Share evidence from the text to support the view that the speaker is determined to make a change in his life and what inspires him to do so? (4)
- (f) Complete the analogy with one word from the passage : (2)
Enormous : Huge :: Supervision : _____
- (g) “I felt that Tom would drift on forever seeking a little wistfully for the dramatic turbulence of some irrecoverable football game.” Explain this line from Paragraph 1 and why the speaker feels so. (4)

3. Write the précis of the following passage in about one-third of its original length: (20)

We must insist that free oratory is only the beginning of free speech; it is not the end, but a means to an end. The end is to find the truth. The practical justification of civil liberty is not that the examination of opinion is one of the necessities of man. For experience tells us that it is only when freedom of opinion becomes the compulsion to debate that the seed which our forefathers planted has produced its fruit. When that is understood, freedom will be cherished not because it is a vent for our opinions but because it is the surest method of correcting them.

‘The unexamined life’, said Socrates, ‘is unfit to be lived by man’. This is the virtue of liberty, and the ground on which we may best justify our belief in it, that it tolerates error in order to serve the truth. When more men are brought face to face with their opponents, forced to listen and learn and mend their ideas, they cease to be children and savages and begin to live like civilized men. Then only is freedom a reality, when men may voice their opinions because they must examine their opinions.

The only reason for dwelling on all this is that if we are to preserve democracy we must understand its principles. And the principle which distinguishes it from all other form of government is that in a democracy the opposition not only is tolerated as constitutional but must be maintained because it is in fact indispensable.

The democratic system cannot be operated without effective opposition. For, in making the great experiment of governing people by consent rather than by coercion, it is not sufficient that the party in power should have a majority. It is just as necessary that the party in power should never outrage the minority. That means that it must listen to the minority and be moved by the criticisms of the minority.

4. Identify the error and rewrite the given sentences: (10×1=10)

- (a) India is independent for the last seventy years.
- (b) I can reproduce this lesson word by word.
- (c) Man is the only animal who can talk.
- (d) The bus left before I reached the station.
- (e) I am looking forward to receive your reply.

- (f) Two-thirds of the book were rubbish.
- (g) One of my favourite fruit is Litchee.
- (h) Jane is more intelligent and wise than Mary.
- (i) Though she is poor, but she is honest.
- (j) A number of shoes are missing.

5. Choose the correct antonym of the given words: (5×1=5)

- (a) Strident - raucous/ soft/ rough/ piercing
- (b) Dank - moist/ torrid/ dry/ damp
- (c) Component - element/ partition/ whole/ aspect
- (d) Friction - dissent/ discord/ variance/ concord
- (e) Conceptual - tangible/ ideal/ notional/ hypothetical

6. Supply a one-word substitute for the given words / sentences : (5×1=5)

- (a) A set of followers, rooms, furniture
- (b) An apartment building in which each apartment is owned separately by the people living in it, but also containing shared areas.
- (c) An object or portion serving as a sample.
- (d) A person who pretends to be what he is not.
- (e) The ability to be easily modified.

7. Fill in the blanks by choosing the correct verb form: (5×1=5)

- (i) Be quiet! The baby _____(sleep).
 - (a) sleeps
 - (b) is sleeping
 - (c) has slept
 - (d) was sleeping
- (ii) Ram lived in Delhi for more than five years. In fact, he _____ there when the riot broke out.
 - (a) lives
 - (b) has been living
 - (c) is living
 - (d) was living
- (iii) It is strange that you _____ (call) because I was just thinking about you.
 - (a) are calling
 - (b) were calling
 - (c) called
 - (d) will call
- (iv) One clown was juggling while he _____ (balance) a glass of wine on his head.
 - (a) was balancing
 - (b) balances
 - (c) balanced
 - (d) had been balancing
- (v) Listen John, I do not care if you missed the bus this morning. You _____ (be) late to work too many times. You are fired!
 - (a) are always
 - (b) have been
 - (c) were late
 - (d) had been

8. Fill in the blanks with the appropriate prepositions. (5×1=5)

- (i) She is proud _____ her achievements.
 - (a) of
 - (b) at
 - (c) in
 - (d) on
- (ii) Mary looks depressed. I think she took the criticism _____ heart.
 - (a) about
 - (b) to
 - (c) for
 - (d) with

(iii) She is well-versed ____ the intricacies of international trade law.

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| (a) by | (b) on |
| (c) in | (d) of |

(iv) He passed the Examination ____ my surprise.

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| (a) for | (b) at |
| (c) on | (d) to |

(v) I cautioned you _____ his tricks.

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|-------------|----------|
| (a) of | (b) with |
| (c) against | (d) over |

9. Choose the correct type of clause for the words underlined in the given sentences.

(5×1=5)

(i) How the budget got in is a mystery.

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| (a) Adjective clause | (b) Noun clause |
| (c) Adverb clause | |

(ii) Even if it were called by another name, a rose would smell sweet.

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|----------------------|-------------------|
| (a) Noun clause | (b) Adverb clause |
| (c) Adjective clause | |

(iii) I did not know what he would do next.

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|----------------------|-----------------------------|
| (a) Adjective clause | (b) Adverb clause of manner |
| (c) Noun clause | |

(iv) I have a box which is filled with almonds.

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|----------------------|-----------------------------|
| (a) Adjective clause | (b) Adverb clause or reason |
| (c) Noun clause | |

(v) He behaves as one would expect him to.

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|----------------------|-------------------|
| (a) Adjective clause | (b) Adverb clause |
| (c) Noun clause | |

10. Change the speech of the following sentences:

(5×1=5)

(a) The teacher said, "Rina, you are a lazy boy."

(b) He said, "Leave the room and do not return here."

(c) The boy said, "Martha broke the glass".

(d) The old man said to the boy, "You little fool! You have ruined me."

(e) We bade goodbye to our guests.

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